

Meta Developer Portal Setup Guide

Complete Non-Developer Guide to Creating a Meta Developer Account & Linking WhatsApp API

Non-Technical Business Edition

What is a Meta Developer Account?

Creating a Meta Developer account does **NOT** require any programming skills! It is simply a free feature by Meta that lets business owners connect automated tools (like your platform chatbot) to their official WhatsApp account. You just use your normal everyday Facebook login.

1 Register Your Free Meta Developer Account (60 Seconds)

1. Open your web browser and go to <https://developers.facebook.com>.
2. Click **Log In** in the top-right corner and sign in using your regular personal Facebook account.
3. Click the **Get Started** (or **Register**) button in the top navigation bar.
4. Accept Meta's Developer terms of service and click **Next**.
5. Verify your mobile phone number via SMS code if prompted.
6. When asked to select your role, choose **Business Owner** or **Administrator**, then click **Complete Registration**.

Result: Your personal Facebook account is now enabled as a Meta Developer! You are ready to create your WhatsApp app.

2 Create Your WhatsApp App

1. From the top header menu, click **My Apps**.
2. Click the green/primary **Create App** button.
3. Select **Other** as your app use case and click **Next**.
4. Select **Business** as your app type and click **Next**.
5. Type an **App Display Name** (e.g. `My Business WhatsApp`).
6. Select your **Meta Business Portfolio** (Business Manager) from the dropdown.
7. Click **Create App** and enter your Facebook password to confirm.

3 Add WhatsApp Product to Your App

1. On your app dashboard screen, scroll down to **Add products to your app**.
2. Find **WhatsApp** and click **Set up**.
3. Select your Meta Business Portfolio if prompted and click **Continue**.

4 Copy Your Credentials to Dashboard

In the left sidebar menu, click **WhatsApp ? API Setup**:

1. **Phone Number ID**: Copy the numeric ID listed under *Step 1: Select phone number* (e.g. `10482019283719`) and paste it into your platform settings.
2. **WhatsApp Business Account ID (WABA ID)**: Copy the numeric ID under *WhatsApp Business Account ID* near the top of the page.
3. **Permanent Access Token**:
 - Go to Meta Business Manager (<https://business.facebook.com>) ? **Settings** ? **Users** ? **System Users**.
 - Click **Add System User**, set Role to **Admin**.
 - Click **Add Assets**, select your App, and grant **Full Control**.
 - Click **Generate Token**, check `whatsapp_business_messaging` and `whatsapp_business_management`, then copy the generated token.

Demystified: **Phone Number ID** is Meta's internal ID for your phone. **WABA ID** is your company's WhatsApp account ID.

5 Copy Your Meta App Secret

1. In the left sidebar menu of Meta Developer Console, click **App settings ? Basic**.
2. Find **App Secret** and click **Show** (re-enter Facebook password if asked).
3. Copy the string of letters and numbers and paste it into your platform dashboard.

6 Configure Inbound Webhooks

1. In the left sidebar menu, click **WhatsApp ? Configuration**.
2. Under **Webhooks**, click **Edit**.
3. In **Callback URL**, paste your platform Webhook URL (copied from your dashboard).
4. In **Verify Token**, invent any secret passphrase (e.g. `my_secret_token_123`) and click **Verify and Save**.
5. Paste that SAME passphrase into the **Webhook Verify Token** field in your platform dashboard.
6. Under Webhook fields, click **Manage** and check `messages` subscription.